identity MQTT/TLS/JSON

Interface Design Description

Service ID: *"identity"*

Abstract
This document describes the MQTT protocol with TLS payload security and JSON payload encoding variant of the `identity` service of the Authentication system.

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1 Overview

This document describes the `identity` service interface of the Authentication system over MQTT, which provides authentication of systems: a system logs in with its credentials and obtains an identity token, which it presents to other systems; providers verify such tokens.

It's implemented using protocol, encoding as stated in below table:

Profile type	Type	Version
Transfer protocol	MQTT	3.1.1 [1]
Data encryption	TLS	1.3 [2], 1.2 [3]
Encoding	JSON	RFC 8259 [4]
Compression	N/A	-
Semantics	N/A	-
Ontology	N/A	-

Table 1: Communication and semantics details used for the `identity` service interface

This document provides the Interface Design Description IDD to the *identity – Service Description* document [5]. The operations, their semantics and the data models are the same as in the HTTP/TLS/JSON IDD [6]; this document specifies the MQTT binding.

The MQTT interface is offered only when the system runs with `mqtt.api.enabled=true`; it is then registered with the interface template `generic_mqtts` (`generic_mqtt` without TLS), the broker address and port (`mqtt.broker.address`, `mqtt.broker.port`) and the base topic `arrowhead/authentication/identity/`. In the Arrowhead-test-cloud-java deployment the MQTT interfaces of the core systems are disabled.

2 Service Operations

The provider subscribes to one topic per operation, the base topic followed by the operation name:

Operation	Request topic
`identity-login`	`arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-login`
`identity-logout`	`arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-logout`
`identity-change-credentials`	`arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-change-credentials`
`identity-verify`	`arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-verify`

A consumer publishes a request envelope (MqttRequestTemplate) to the topic and receives the answer (MqttResponseTemplate) on its own `responseTopic`. The `authentication` field carries the requester's identity according to the provider's authentication policy: `IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>` (outsourced or internal policy), `SYSTEM//<name>` (declared policy) or the requester's X.509 certificate (certificate policy). The `status` of the response uses the HTTP status code numbers (200, 201, 204, 400, 401, 403, 404, 408, 423, 500, 503); on error the payload is an ErrorMessage.

```
{
  "traceId": "a1b2c3",
  "authentication": "IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>",
  "responseTopic": "arrowhead/response/TemperatureDisplay/a1b2c3",
  "qosRequirement": 1,
  "params": {},
  "payload": {}
}
```

Listing 1: Request envelope.

```
{
  "status": 200,
  "traceId": "a1b2c3",
  "receiver": "TemperatureDisplay",
  "payload": {}
}
```

Listing 2: Response envelope.

2.1 PUBLISH `arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-login`

Operation: identity-login
Input: IdentityRequest
Output: IdentityLoginResponse

Checks the credentials and opens a session. Returns the identity token and its expiry (`identity.token.duration`, 300 s in the default configuration). A previous token of the system becomes invalid.

```
{
  "systemName": "TemperatureSensor",
  "credentials": {
    "password": "<password>"
  }
}
```

Listing 3: Payload of an identity-login request.

2.2 PUBLISH arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-logout

Operation: identity-logout
Input: IdentityRequest

Checks the credentials and closes the session of the system.

```
{
  "systemName": "TemperatureSensor",
  "credentials": {
    "password": "<password>"
  }
}
```

Listing 4: Payload of an identity-logout request.

2.3 PUBLISH arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-change-credentials

Operation: identity-change-credentials
Input: IdentityChangeRequest

Checks the current credentials and replaces them with the new ones.

```
{
  "systemName": "TemperatureSensor",
  "credentials": {
    "password": "<password>"
  },
  "newCredentials": {
    "password": "<password>"
  }
}
```

Listing 5: Payload of an identity-change-credentials request.

2.4 PUBLISH arrowhead/authentication/identity/identity-verify

Operation: identity-verify
Input: String
Output: IdentityVerifyResponse

Checks an identity token. Returns whether it is valid and, if so, the system, its sysop flag, login and expiry time. The caller must itself present a valid identity token (only `login`, `logout` and `change` are token-free).

```
"<token>"
```

Listing 6: Payload of an identity-verify request.

3 Data Models

Here, all data objects that can be part of the service calls associated with this service are listed in alphabetic order. Each *struct* denotes a JSON Object with the named fields; fields that are not needed may be omitted.

3.1 struct MqttRequestTemplate

The request envelope.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"traceId"	String	Identifier chosen by the requester, returned in the response.
"authentication"	String	Identity of the requester (see Section 2).
"responseTopic"	String	Topic on which the response is published.
"qosRequirement"	Number	MQTT QoS of the response (0, 1 or 2).
"params"	Object<String>	Optional parameters (the query parameters of the HTTP binding).
"payload"	Object	The operation input.

3.2 struct MqttResponseTemplate

The response envelope.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"status"	Number	Status code.
"traceId"	String	The trace identifier of the request.
"receiver"	String	Name of the requester.
"payload"	Object	The operation output, or an ErrorMessage.

3.3 struct ErrorMessage

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"errorMessage"	String	
"errorCode"	Number	
"exceptionType"	ExceptionType	
"origin"	String	

3.4 struct IdentityChangeRequest

Changes the credentials of the requesting system.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"systemName"	String	Name of the system, PascalCase (e.g. `TemperatureSensor`).
"credentials"	Object<String>	Credentials of the authentication method, for `PASSWORD` the key `password`.
"newCredentials"	Object<String>	The new credentials.

3.5 struct IdentityLoginResponse

The identity token issued at login.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"token"	String	The identity token, used as `Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>`.
"expirationTime"	DateTime	UTC time when the identity token expires.

3.6 struct IdentityRequest

System name and credentials.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"systemName"	String	Name of the system, PascalCase (e.g. `TemperatureSensor`).
"credentials"	Object<String>	Credentials of the authentication method, for `PASSWORD` the key `password`.

3.7 struct IdentityVerifyResponse

Result of verifying an identity token.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"verified"	Boolean	True when the token is valid.
"systemName"	String	System the token belongs to.
"sysop"	Boolean	Whether that system is a system operator.
"loginTime"	DateTime	UTC time of the login.
"expirationTime"	DateTime	UTC time when the identity token expires.

3.8 Primitives

As all messages are encoded using the JSON format [4], the following primitive constructs, part of that standard, become available.

Type	Description
Boolean	JSON Boolean, `true` or `false`.
DateTime	JSON String with an ISO 8601 UTC timestamp, e.g. `2026-10-22T12:00:00Z`.
ExceptionType	One of `ARROWHEAD`, `INVALID_PARAMETER`, `AUTH`, `FORBIDDEN`, `DATA_NOT_FOUND`, `TIMEOUT`, `LOCKED`, `INTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR`, `EXTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR` (JSON String).
Number	JSON Number, an integer.
Object	JSON Object; Object<A> has string keys and values of type A.
String	JSON String.

4 References

[1] A. Banks and R. Gupta, “Mqtt version 3.1.1,” OASIS, Standard, 2014.

[2] E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.3,” IETF, RFC 8446, 2018.

[3] T. Dierks and E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.2,” IETF, RFC 5246, 2008.

[4] T. Bray, “The javascript object notation (json) data interchange format,” IETF, RFC 8259, 2017.

[5] J. Delsing, “identity – Service Description (Authentication),” Eclipse Arrowhead, SD 5.2.2, 2026, authentication-v5.2.2-identity-SD.pdf.

[6] ——, “identity HTTP/TLS/JSON – Interface Design Description (Authentication),” Eclipse Arrowhead, IDD 5.2.2, 2026, authentication-v5.2.2-identity-HTTP-IDD.pdf.

5 Revision History

5.1 Amendments

No.	Date	Version	Subject of Amendments	Author
1	2026-10-22	5.2.2	Document created from the Arrowhead LaTeX templates for the 5.2.2 Java Spring implementation, including the local extensions of this workspace.	Jerker Delsing

5.2 Quality Assurance

No.	Date	Version	Approved by
1		5.2.2	